



**BIRLA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY AND SCIENCE, Pilani**  
**Pilani Campus**  
**AUGS/ AGSR Division**

**FIRST SEMESTER 2026 - 27**  
**COURSE HANDOUT**

**Date: 03.08.2026**

In addition to part I (General Handout for all courses appended to the Time table) this portion gives further specific details regarding the course.

**Course No** : GS F342  
**Course Title** : **Computer-Mediated Communication**  
**Instructor-in-Charge** : **Virendra Singh Nirban**

**1. Course Description:**

Computer Mediated Communication- Definitions and overview; Evolution of Computer Mediated Communication; Components of Computer Mediated Communication; Computer Mediated Discourse Analysis- Theories and faceted Approach; Information-Interactivity Dynamism in Computer Mediated Communication; Gender perspectives in Computer Mediated Communication; Privacy Issues in Computer Mediated Communication; Socialization in Social Media-Profiles, Identity and traversal; Computer Mediated Communication and technology acceptance; Computer Mediated Communication Theories; Human-Computer Interfaces.

**2. Scope and Objective of the Course:**

The objective of the course is to acquaint students with the practical and theoretical issues associated with computer-mediated communication (CMC) systems. The focus of the course will be on CMC and its influence on society as a mode of communication.

**3. Text Books:**

The readings in this course include current academic research articles, "classic" texts from the area of computer-mediated communication, book chapters, and some popular-press pieces.

**4. Reference Books:**

Reference Material to be distributed in the classroom.

**5. Course Plan:**

| <b>Module No.</b> | <b>Lecture Session</b>                                                     | <b>Reference</b>                                                                                                 | <b>Learning outcomes</b>                                                                                                 |
|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1-6               | CMC- Definitions and overview; Evolution of CMC; Components of CMC         | Licklider J. C. R. & Taylor, R. W. : The computer as a communication device.                                     | Understanding of CMC as a mode of communication, underlying assumptions and perspectives                                 |
| 7-9               | Freedom of speech and Social Media, accessibility and affordability of CMC | Herring, S. C. : Slouching toward the ordinary: Current trends in computer-mediated communication.               | Learning about the accessibility and affordability of CMC and its effect on communication integration and interpretation |
| 10-15             | Socialization in Social Media-Profiles, Identity and traversal             | Ellison, N, & boyd, d.: Situating social network sites in context. In: Sociability through social network sites. | Understanding the dynamics of social structures on online/virtual world, identities in online world                      |
| 16-22             | Computer Mediated Discourse Analysis- Theories                             | Herring, S. C. : A faceted classification scheme for                                                             | Understanding how to interpret vast amount of text and other                                                             |



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|       |                                                                               |                                                                 |                                                                                 |
|-------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|       | and a faceted Approach                                                        | computer-mediated discourse.                                    | media on internet                                                               |
| 23-28 | Language and culture in CMC                                                   | David Crystal: Past, Present and Future of World Language.      | Learning the language and cultural perspectives of technology interventions     |
| 29-32 | Information sharing and Privacy Issues in CMC                                 | Joinson and Paine: Self Discourse: Privacy and Internet.        | Understanding how information is used to violate privacy and related issues     |
| 33-35 | Factors influencing sociability and usability of CMC                          | Jenny Preece: Sociability and Usability in Online Communities   | Understanding factors influencing sociability and usability of online platforms |
| 36-38 | Information-Interactivity Dynamism in CMC; Gender perspectives in CMC         | Joseph Walther: Theories of CMC and Interpersonal Relationships | Learning the dynamics of how the information is perceived and Consumed          |
| 39-42 | CMC and technology acceptance behavior of users; technology adoption behavior | David and Venkatesh; Technology Acceptance Theories             | Understanding various theories of user acceptance of technology                 |

**6. Evaluation Scheme:**

| Component          | Duration | Weightage (%) | Date & Time           | Nature of component (Close Book/ Open Book) |
|--------------------|----------|---------------|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Mid-Semester Test  | 90 Mins. | 30 %          | As announced by AUGSD | CLOSED BOOK                                 |
| Comprehensive Test | 180 Mins | 40 %          | As announced by AUGSD | CLOSED BOOK                                 |
| Assignments        |          | 30 %          | TBA                   | OPEN BOOK                                   |

**Closed Book Test:** No reference material of any kind will be permitted during the test.

**Open Book Exam:** Use of printed/written reference material (books and notebooks) will be permitted. Computers / Devices of any kind will not be allowed.

**Attendance Policy:** Each student is expected to attend all classes and participate in all evaluation components.

**Criterion for NC:** [20% of the average of the top three performers or 30% of the median, whichever is lower.]

**Note:** It shall be the responsibility of the individual student to be regular in maintaining the self-study schedule as given in the course handout and attend lectures. If the student cannot appear for the Regular Test/Examination due to genuine exigencies, the student must refer to the procedure for applying for a Make-up Examination. No make-up for the tutorials.

**Chamber Consultation Hour:** Friday, 5-H

V S Nirban  
**Instructor-in-charge**  
**Course No. GSF342**